

Politoed Rain TR - Bring & Lead Sheet

Reg M-C ladder: no side ran this exact six; 721 sides ran four or more of them and count where their lead and four sit inside these six. Pages 3-4 are the theorised plans.

THE SIX

					
Golisopod	Charizard	Politoed	Archaludon	Grimmsnarl	Farigiraf
0% brought 33% led	0% brought 0% led	0% brought 33% led	0% brought 33% led	0% brought 0% led	0% brought 100% led

MOST COMMON LEADS

 	Golisopod + Grimmsnarl	25x	48%
 	Archaludon + Grimmsnarl	20x	60%
 	Farigiraf + Golisopod	15x	73%
 	Farigiraf + Grimmsnarl	11x	64%
 	Archaludon + Farigiraf	7x	71%
 	Charizard + Grimmsnarl	5x	60%
 	Archaludon + Politoed	4x	75%

MOST COMMON FOURS

   	12x	33%
   	11x	55%
   	7x	43%
   	1x	0%

Counts and win rates on this page use the pooled 103 sides. With samples this size a win rate carries roughly +/-10 points at 95% confidence overall and far more per row, so read them as directions. A four is only counted when all four were revealed in the game. Sprites: Pokemon Showdown gen5 set.

What to bring into what

Conditioned on the opponent showing this Pokemon at team preview. GAMES = pooled sides (exact-six sides in brackets).

OPPONENT	GAMES	WIN	BRING THIS FOUR	LEAD	BEST-PERFORMING FOUR
 Rillaboom	55 (2)	64%	    8 games, 38% win	  12 games, 50% win	    6 games, 50% win
 Sneasler	46 (2)	67%	    6 games, 50% win	  14 games, 43% win	    5 games, 60% win
 Kingambit	30 (0)	60%	    4 games, 0% win	  7 games, 14% win	    3 games, 67% win
 Salamence	30 (2)	73%	    4 games, 75% win	  6 games, 50% win	    same as default
 Indeedee-F	24 (1)	71%	    2 games, 50% win	  9 games, 56% win	
 Incineroar	24 (0)	67%	    4 games, 75% win	  5 games, 60% win	    same as default
 Arcanine-H	19 (1)	63%	    4 games, 50% win	  6 games, 67% win	    same as default
 Floette-E	18 (0)	67%	    4 games, 0% win	  6 games, 67% win	    same as default
 Golisopod	17 (0)	65%	    3 games, 100% win	  7 games, 71% win	    same as default
 Farigiraf	14 (0)	71%	    3 games, 0% win	  3 games, 33% win	    same as default

BRING THIS FOUR = the four these players most often brought into that opponent. BEST-PERFORMING FOUR = the highest win rate among fours used at least 3 times in that matchup; where it differs from the default it is the smaller sample, so it is a lead to test, not an instruction.

Game plans

Theorised from the calc pages, the pooled ladder sides and the Baltimore Round 9 games. Lead on the left, back pair on the right.

THE THREE MODES

 	back	 	Rain pressure (Aditya's default) <i>Into: Bulky and Trick Room teams: Gardevoir, Indeezee, Farigiraf, Milotic, Salamence</i> Muddy Water + Snarl spread chip on turn 1. Archaludon survives Helping Hand Hyper Voice and stacks Stamina. Farigiraf reverses their Trick Room; Golisopod at 60 Speed cleans under it.
 	back	 	Screens Trick Room (ladder's most common lead) <i>Into: Fast physical goodstuff: Rillaboom, Sneasler, Incineroar, Arcanine-H</i> Screen + Mega Golisopod pressure turn 1, Trick Room from Farigiraf behind Armor Tail. Drill Run is 4x on Hisuian Arcanine; Golisopod takes Close Combat neutrally.
 	back	 	Sun fast mode <i>Into: Teams with no fast Rock, Water or Electric: Rillaboom, Kingambit, Gholdengo cores</i> Heat Wave in sun OHKO's Rillaboom, Kingambit and Gholdengo as a spread move. Politoed stays home so the weathers do not fight.

CHARIZARD LEADS WITHOUT GOLISOPOD

 	back	 	Screens sun <i>Into: Rillaboom goodstuff, Kingambit, Gholdengo, Milotic. Not into Rock or rain teams.</i> Screen up while Charizard Protects or fires Heat Wave. Behind the screen: Sucker Punch 47-56% (was 70-83%), Salamence Double-Edge 77-91% (was a KO), Gholdengo Shadow Ball 36-42%. Zap Cannon is still a 91-108% roll.
 	back	 	Armor Tail sun (first choice) <i>Into: Rillaboom, Kingambit, Incineroar: the priority teams.</i> Armor Tail cancels Fake Out, Sucker Punch, Extreme Speed, First Impression and Grassy Glide aimed at either mon, so Heat Wave gets clicked. Psychic OHKO's Sneasler, the one thing faster than Charizard on those teams. Trick Room is a bluff or a bail-out.
 	back	 	Snarl sun <i>Into: Special Trick Room teams: Gardevoir, Indeezee, Farigiraf, Delphox.</i> Snarl drops both special attackers on turn 1 while Heat Wave does 56-67% to Mega Gardevoir, Indeezee and Farigiraf. Electro Shot needs a charge in sun, so Archaludon leans on Dragon Pulse and Snarl. Politoed is the weather reset in the back.
 	back	 	Rain into sun <i>Into: Anywhere the rain lead is right but Golisopod is a bad closer (Fire-heavy backs).</i> Two turns of Muddy Water and Snarl in rain, then Charizard comes in and Mega Evolves: Drought fires on the Mega, flipping to sun. Politoed's Weather Ball becomes Fire and does 83-99% to Rillaboom, 71-84% to Kingambit, so it keeps attacking after the flip.

- Drought fires when Charizard Mega Evolves, not when it enters: you choose the turn the weather flips.
- Weather is set slowest-last, so the slower setter wins. Politoed (90) beats Charizard-Y and Ninetales but loses to Torkoal (40).
- Armor Tail blocks priority aimed at Farigiraf or its partner. A Farigiraf lead switches off Fake Out, Sucker Punch and First Impression for the whole side.
- Charizard never leads into Hisuian Arcanine, Mega Tyranitar, Basculegion or Mega Raichu Y. Those are the Golisopod or Trick Room bring.

What to bring into what (theory)

Per opponent core: the lead, the four, and the calc that decides it. Page 2 is what the ladder actually did; this page is the plan.

OPPONENT	LEAD	BRING THIS FOUR	WHY
Rillaboom	 	   	Politoed sits: Grassy Glide is a 3/16 roll even at 16 Def. Armor Tail turns off Fake Out and Grassy Glide.
Sneasler	 	   	Golisopod takes Close Combat neutrally; Farigiraf Psychic OHKOs it (171-201%).
Salamence	 	   	Ice Beam OHKOs; Electro Shot in rain 63-74%; Golisopod resists Hyper Voice.
Gardevoir / Indeedee TR	 	   	The Baltimore plan (won 2-1). Snarl before their Hyper Voice; your Trick Room cancels theirs.
Arcanine-Hisui	 	   	Drill Run is 4x. Never lead Charizard (Head Smash 372%) or Politoed (77%).
Kingambit	 	   	Heat Wave in sun OHKOs it (114-136%); Armor Tail blocks Sucker Punch; Reflect makes Kowtow into Farigiraf survivable.
Raichu-Mega-Y	 	   	Zap Cannon OHKOs Politoed and Charizard, both stay home. Armor Tail blocks Fake Out; Trick Room; Drill Run OHKOs Raichu.
Gholdengo	 	   	Heat Wave OHKOs (140-166%); Light Screen cuts Shadow Ball to 36-42%. Drill Run is the second Ground hit.
Pelipper / Basculegion rain	 	   	Politoed resets rain when it enters last. Electro Shot OHKOs Basculegion; Grass Knot 53-63% on it.
Tyranitar / Excadrill sand	 	   	Rain overwrites sand and switches Sand Rush off. Grass Knot on Tyranitar is 120 BP super effective. No Charizard.